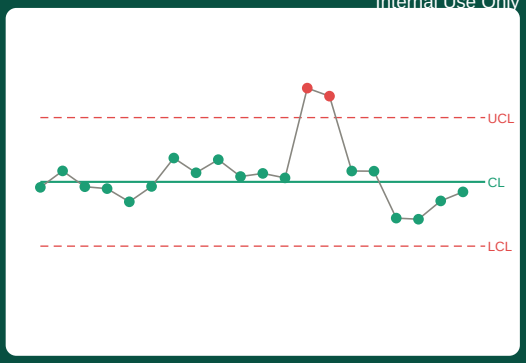
Internal Use Only

SPC

Apply Statistical Process Control charts to distinguish common cause variation (normal) from special causes requiring



WHEN TO USE

In any repetitive process where consistency matters — production, service delivery, data processing, clinical care.

HOW TO APPLY — STEPS

1. Select the quality characteristic to monitor
2. Choose the appropriate chart type (X-bar R, p-chart, u-chart, etc.)
3. Calculate control limits from baseline stable-process data
4. Plot new data points in real time as the process runs
5. React to special cause signals only — investigate and eliminate them

PRACTITIONER TIP

! Never tamper with a process that is in statistical control. Tampering only adds variation and makes things worse.

KEY OUTPUTS

- Control charts with calculated limits
- Process capability indices (Cp, Cpk)
- Special cause event log and investigation log

HOW TO MEASURE SUCCESS

Cpk trend over time; number of special cause events per month; false alarm rate

TOOL CATEGORY

Quality & Process